

attention, and tourism.

In a remarkable moment that has elevated Bihar's position on India's sporting map, the 7th edition of the Khelo India Youth Games (KIYG) was successfully hosted in the state in May 2025. The event marked a significant achievement not just in terms of sports participation and infrastructure development, but also in terms of the transformative leadership of Bihar's Chief Minister, Nitish Kumar. Under his direct supervision and persistent vision, Bihar emerged not only as a host but as a bold claimant to future leadership in India's evolving sporting ecosystem. The magnitude of the event was unprecedented in Bihar's history. Spanning 12 days, the Khelo India Youth Games 2025 brought together over 6000 athletes from across 36 states and union territories. These participants competed across 28 disciplines ranging from athletics, boxing, and wrestling to indigenous sports like

As stadiums rise, scholarships reach young athletes, and training centres nurture hidden talent, Bihar is scripting a **new narrative** — one of strength, stamina, and spirit.

kho-kho, kabaddi, and thang-ta. The Games were spread across five cities — Patna, Rajgir, Gaya, Bhagalpur, and Begusarai — each hosting multiple disciplines and welcoming waves of enthusiastic participants, officials, and spectators. Hosting an event of this scale demanded enormous logistical coordination, which was efficiently orchestrated by the state under the leadership of Nitish Kumar.

Rajgir's International Sports City

The crown jewel of Bihar's sports renaissance is currently under development in Rajgir. A massive 90-acre land parcel has been acquired for the construction of a State Sports Academy-cum-International Cricket Stadium. With an investment of ₹740 crore, this project is one of the most ambitious in the state's history. The foundation stone was laid by Chief Minister Nitish Kumar on 12 October 2018. Designed to meet international standards, the stadium is being constructed by the Shapoorji Pallonji Group and is modelled after the Sydney Cricket Ground.

Spread across 90 acres, the stadium will have a seating capacity of approximately 45,000, making it

the largest in Bihar. It will feature modern amenities such as dedicated pavilions for players, VIP stands, coaches' boxes, cafeterias, and rest areas for spectators.

It is part of the larger Rajgir Sports Complex, which aims to support over 25 sports including hockey, football, swimming, kabaddi, volleyball, and wrestling. The stadium will also include a sports academy, research and training centers, a library, and indoor facilities.

Once completed, it is expected to serve as the home ground for the Bihar cricket team and host national and international matches, contributing significantly to the growth of sports infrastructure in the state. Once completed, the complex will feature world-class amenities for cricket and other sports, residential facilities for athletes, and centres for research and sports medicine. It is designed not just as a venue but as a full-fledged ecosystem where excellence is nurtured, and champions are created. This project symbolises Bihar's transition from a state with isolated athletes to a state that builds champions.

Breathing New Life into Patna's Iconic Moin-ul-Haq Stadium

Another key milestone is the

